



NARRATIVE REPORT FOR SEPTEMBER 2025

INTRODUCTION

In the heart of Taru, Kwale County, Kenya Keys continues to stand as a strong pillar of opportunity and transformation, changing lives one student, one family, and one story at a time. September was more than just another month on the calendar; it was a season of opportunity, resilience, and growth across the communities we serve.

From the dreams of students stepping into college and university for the first time, to the quiet determination seen in evening reading sessions at our library, the impact of our work was felt deeply. Our Gender Department reached girls with not only essential health supplies but also dignity and encouragement. In every mentorship session, a young mind found guidance. In every library visit, a future was shaped.

Every effort made this month echoes our mission to break the chains of poverty through education and opportunity and behind every success story is a sponsor, a supporter and a believer.

This report outlines the key activities, achievements, and progress made by each department during the month of September.

SPONSORSHIP DEPARTMENT

September was a dynamic and fulfilling month for the Sponsorship Department, marked by key milestones in student support and program growth. The Department successfully facilitated the transition of our newly sponsored students into universities and colleges, ensuring they received the guidance and resources needed to start this next chapter with confidence.

Our commitment to student welfare remained strong, with continued efforts in mentorship, emotional and academic support, and close follow-up with all beneficiaries. We also experienced a steady rise in sponsorship applications, reflecting growing community trust in our program.

This report provides a summary of the core activities undertaken by the Department in September. We thank all our sponsors and partners for making this work possible, your impact continues to open doors and transform lives.

1. September College Intake

As the month of September unfolded, so did a new chapter in the lives of many of our sponsored students. With great pride and anticipation, the Department supported the successful transition of several students into universities and colleges, a significant milestone not just for the students themselves, but for their families and communities as well.

We recognize that stepping into higher education comes with both excitement and challenges. That's why the department has remained deeply committed to ensuring a smooth and supportive transition for every student. From helping them settle into their new environments to offering guidance and resources, the department has worked to make sure no one walks this journey alone.

These young scholars, many of whom are the first in their families to pursue higher education, now carry with them not only books and dreams but also the belief that someone invested in their future. Thanks to our sponsor's unwavering support.



Full of gratitude and excitement! Our sponsored students at Bomet university.



The smile says it all..., students at their new institutions.

2. Sponsorship Applications Increase

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to our dedicated sponsors whose continued support has made it possible for many bright and deserving students to pursue their education. Your generosity has opened doors that would have otherwise remained closed, allowing students to dream bigger and aim higher. The impact is clearly being felt across our communities.

As a result of this growing impact, September recorded a significant increase in sponsorship applications, with more needy and academically gifted students seeking opportunities to continue their studies (40 for secondary school sponsorship and 87 for college and university sponsorships). This growing demand is a powerful indicator of both the value of the program and the urgent need for more sponsorship slots.

While we celebrate the success of those already sponsored, it is evident that many more are waiting for the same chance; young minds full of potential but lacking the financial means to move forward.



Hopeful applicants seeking sponsorship to pursue their education and transform their future.

3. Student Support and Welfare

The Department continued to uphold its core value of holistic student support. Beyond academic sponsorship, the department remains actively involved in responding to students' health, safety, and emotional well-being.

During the month, the department intervened in several special cases:

- **#22-02:** Required assistance for eye treatment and replacement of glasses.
- **#22-04:** was taken to hospital and received physiotherapy support due to complications related to a previous limb condition.
- **#22-18:** She required gynecological services (due to some health conditions that had arisen)

These interventions ensured that no student's education was disrupted due to health or financial constraints, and the team is always ready to support the students.



Unwell but hopeful students, grateful for medical support.

LIBRARY DEPARTMENT

September was another remarkable month for the Library Department; a month filled with creativity, learning and community engagement. The library continued to serve as a beacon of knowledge, fun and togetherness for children, students and community members. Through our daily reading sessions, service desk operations, school collaborations and outreach activities, the library upheld its mission of empowering minds and transforming lives through education.

Below are the key activities carried out within the month:

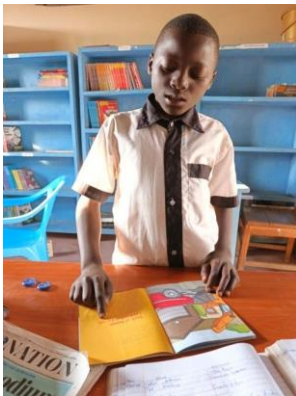
1. Daily evening reading and game playing sessions

Throughout the month, the library hosted daily evening reading and game-playing sessions under the after-school program. These sessions attracted an average of 25 learners each evening, primarily school-going children who came to read, play, and interact after their classes. Each session ran approximately

one hour, providing learners with a balanced environment of learning leisure. Activities included group reading, storytelling, spelling games; board games like Jig saw fit word puzzle game, and team challenges that enhanced their cognitive and social skills.

The sessions were highly interactive, fun, and educative, creating a safe and supportive space for children to improve their reading habits, build confidence, and form positive peer relationships. Older pupils also played mentorship roles, assisting young readers with pronunciation and comprehension.

The consistent participation demonstrated the growing love for reading and the trust that parents and schools have placed in the Kenya keys community library as an essential part of their children's development.



Students having different activities at the library.

2. Service desk operations and library usage

The library service desk remained a central point of contact for all library operations, offering services such as book lending, information inquiries, consultations, and daily attendance recording.

Patrons continued to make full use of the available resources, including textbooks, revision materials, and storybooks. Through close interaction with users, the library staff provided reading guidance, assisted in book selection, and answered academic-related queries.

- Total number of visitors: 483
- Books borrowed: 124
- Books returned :101
- Books renewed: 23

The statistics highlight the library's continued relevance and growing usage among both students and teachers.



Students at the service desk waiting to capture their attendance in the library and a teacher from the NFE center preparing for his class lesson.

3. NFE issuance of certificates and trophy handing over.

Following the international literacy day celebration that took place at Kwale town hosted by Kwale county on 8th of September 2025 which is celebrated worldwide every year to highlight the importance of literacy to individuals, communities, and societies and to promote efforts towards a more literate world.

During this event, Kenya keys organization was recognized and awarded as the best NG`O in supporting non formal education program for its outstanding contribution to the Taru non formal education center. This center was further recommended for recording the highest number of successful candidates of 213 and for being the most improved center in academic performance within the country.

Due to this commendable work at Taru NFE center, therefore, the Samburu subcounty director of adult education officially visited the Taru center to formally handover the trophy to Kenya keys organization (***represented by the Kenya keys senior office of operations and the liaison officer to NFE***) and issue academic certificates to the 2023 cohort of students at the Taru non formal classes.

This event marked a moment of great pride and accomplishment for both the students and the Kenya keys organization.

The recognition stands as a statement to Kenya keys' continued dedication to promoting quality education, empowering learners even in the non-formal sections and fostering academic excellence within the Taru community and beyond.



NFE students receiving certificates and Trophy. Thankful for the program Potentials unlocked!

GENDER AND AFFIRMATIVE ACTION DEPARTMENT

The Kenya Keys Organization, through the Gender and affirmative action department and partner programs, has continued to implement key initiatives aimed at enhancing education, promoting health awareness, and supporting student welfare across the community. The activities undertaken in September reflect the organization's ongoing commitment to empowering learners, particularly girls, through mentorship, capacity building, and resource provision.

Key engagements included the Kazamoyo Health Talk, which focused on guiding young girls toward disciplined goal-setting and positive life choices; participation in the Whispers of Deaf Event, which promoted inclusivity and the recognition of the rights of persons with disabilities; continued student support through the Usalama Program and Vital Students Support initiatives; and the expansion of the Tech-Lit Program, which equips learners with essential digital literacy skills.

Collectively, these initiatives demonstrate Kenya Keys Organization's dedication to fostering holistic development, reducing barriers to education, and strengthening community resilience through education, empowerment, and collaboration.

1. Kazamoyo Health Talk

In September the GAA department spearheaded a comprehensive health and motivational session at Kazamoyo Primary School. The event successfully brought together 197 adolescent girls out of the projected 200 girls from three neighboring schools ; Kazamoyo, Shaurimoyo, and Kanjaocha schools reflecting an impressive turnout and community interest.

The interactive session focused on empowering young girls with practical knowledge and soft skills centered around the following areas of focus.

- SMART goal setting and structured life planning. Each student was encouraged to set achievable goals in their education and ensure they strive to attain them.
- Time management and personal accountability. Students were talked to about using their time well, giving first priority to education, for it is the only way to change lives.
- Recognizing and overcoming societal and personal obstacles. Speakers encouraged the girls to first identify the problems facing them and help each other in solving those problems.
- Maintaining academic focus despite external pressures, it was made clear that external pressures will always be present, what makes the difference is how one handles them and the ability to remain focused on what matters.

From the session it was evident that many of the girls come from families that struggle to afford even the most basic necessities, and sanitary towels remain an ongoing challenge. As a result, many girls miss school during their menstrual periods, fall behind academically, and suffer from low self-esteem due to the fear of staining their clothes. Sadly, some even become vulnerable to exploitation, leading to early pregnancies and interrupted education.

To combat menstrual-related absenteeism, Kenya Keys through the GAA Department provided 197 washable hygiene kits, a critical intervention that promotes menstrual hygiene management and enhances school attendance.

We are deeply grateful to our partners and sponsors for the donation of long-lasting and cost-effective washable sanitary towels. The donation is doing far more than meeting a physical need; it is restoring dignity, building confidence, and unlocking the potential of girls who are now able to attend school without shame or interruption.

Through the thoughtful contribution, the girls can now walk into classrooms with confidence and comfort, fully prepared to pursue their dreams. You not only provided a product; you have provided hope, opportunity and freedom.

The head teacher expressed deep appreciation for the initiative and requested that such impactful engagements be conducted on a termly basis to ensure sustainability and long-term impact.





The smiles of dignity and confidence, every girl deserves access to menstrual health. Thanks to our partners.

2. Whispers of Deaf Event

In a powerful demonstration of inclusion, Kenya Keys participated in the deaf awareness week through a collaborative event with the community-based organization, Whispers of Deaf. The event was held at Kafuduni School for the Deaf; the event celebrated the rights, abilities, and achievements of deaf learners in the region.

The day's activities included singing the national anthem led by deaf scouts, followed by a vibrant showcase of student exhibitions in baking, visual arts, music, and dance, many of which had reached the national level of the Kenya Music Festival. The event culminated in a creative fashion show highlighting appropriate dress codes for various occasions.

Kenya Keys Organization donated 50 hygiene kits to support girls from disadvantaged backgrounds within the school. Like other girls, deaf students also face significant challenges related to menstruation. The team provided training on proper use, cleaning, and storage of the kits to ensure safe and long term use. The organization reaffirmed its commitment to supporting all girls regardless of background or ability, under the guiding principles of equality, care, and inclusivity.

The event aimed to raise awareness within the community that deaf individuals have voices, can express themselves, and deserve recognition and inclusion. Under the theme “*There is No Human Rights Without Sign Language*,” the event celebrated the abilities and achievements of deaf students.





Kenya keys staff attending an event meant for Deaf Awareness.

3. Usalama Program

Beyond academic sponsorship, the Usalama Program continues to provide comprehensive welfare support for high school students from vulnerable backgrounds. This includes assistance with transportation, basic shopping, uniform repair, and healthcare to ensure students remain comfortable and focused on their studies.

During the month, the program served 28 cases, including four non-sponsored students who sought emergency support to remain in school. The support covered emergency transport for students affected by school fires and medical assistance for those who were unwell

4. Vital Students Support

The Vital Students Support initiative, an integral component of Kenya Keys' post-secondary support strategy, continued to provide financial and logistical assistance to sponsored students.

In the reporting back to school period, the organization supported 55 students. The funds covered upkeep, accommodation, transportation, and medical needs, ensuring students' continued well-being and academic progress.

5. TechLit Program

The TechLit Program, a partnership initiative under Kenya Keys, aims to enhance digital literacy among young learners. It currently operates in four schools within the organization's service area.

September marked the addition of a fifth institution, Fuleye Primary School to the program. Classroom preparations were finalized, and ongoing classes across participating schools reported steady progress in both project work and class performance. The initiative continues to equip learners with essential digital skills, positioning them for success in an increasingly technology driven world.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to Tech-lit Africa for their generous support and for believing in the potential of our students. Their contribution is not just about computers, it's about giving young people the tools to dream bigger, connect globally, and compete equally in a fast-evolving digital age.

As this partnership grows, so will the opportunities for our students, who now have a chance to learn skills that can shape their futures and ultimately uplift their entire communities.



Above: the ongoing construction of the Fuleye Primary Techlit Class.



Below: Students attending a Techlit Class after it was stocked with laptops.

MENTORSHIP DEPARTMENT

September was one of the most engaging and fulfilling months for the Mentorship Department. Throughout the month, mentors were actively involved in a range of activities that demonstrated their unwavering commitment to nurturing, guiding, and supporting students across different levels of education. The department's work this month was centered on both academic and personal empowerment, with a deliberate focus on promoting access to education, encouraging life skills development, and responding to the unique welfare needs of individual students.

To achieve these objectives, the department engaged in a variety of activities including administrative roles, mentorship sessions, incentive distributions, and financial interventions under the Hope Spring Kit Support Program, as well as community outreach and collaborative activities. The following report provides a detailed account of these efforts and their impact throughout the month.

1. September intake college reporting.

In September, mentors played a vital role in supporting students as they transitioned to university and college. The mentorship team accompanied students during the reporting process, offering not only logistical support but also emotional encouragement and practical guidance.

Mentors took this opportunity to provide valuable insights on what to expect in the next phase of life — including academic responsibilities, independence, time management, and the importance of personal discipline. These sessions helped ease the anxiety of transition and prepared students to face new environments with confidence and clarity.

Their presence reinforced the organization's commitment to holistic student development, ensuring that students feel supported both inside and outside the classroom.



Mentors helping students travel and getting admitted to different institutions

2. Mentorship and Incentive Distribution

Another key objective for the month was the distribution of incentive to all nine primary schools served under the Kenya Keys mentorship program. The mentors carried out this exercise efficiently in the early weeks of September, ensuring that every student benefited. Each pupil received a packet of laundry soap, while all girls in the project received a packet of sanitary towels. This exercise was not merely a distribution of items; it represented the organization's deep understanding of the importance of hygiene and dignity among school-going children, particularly those from vulnerable backgrounds. The simple yet meaningful activity helped ease the daily struggles that many of the students face and motivated them to attend school regularly and confidently.

In addition to the incentive distribution, mentors took the opportunity to conduct interactive mentorship sessions in each of the schools. The topics covered during these sessions were self-awareness, empathy, creative thinking, and critical thinking, all of which are essential life skills that play a significant role in shaping responsible and reflective individuals. The sessions provided students with an open platform to express themselves, reflect on their personal goals, and learn how to better interact with others in their environment. Many students responded positively, showing a deeper sense of self-understanding and motivation to improve both their academic and personal lives.



Mentors teaching during the Hope Spring School session



Grateful Students posing for a photo with their incentives

3. Hope Spring Support Kit

As part of the monthly responsibilities, mentors also handled several Hope Spring kit support cases that had been reported to the department by either parents, students, or teachers. The economic hardships currently being experienced across many households have continued to affect students' ability to access education consistently. Many families are struggling with limited income, and most depend on small casual jobs to survive. Considering these realities, the Hope Spring Kit continues to be a lifeline for many learners who would otherwise be forced to drop out of school.

During the month, one of the most remarkable cases involved Neema Ngala, a bright and active student enrolled in the Tech Lit class at Taru Primary School. Neema had been experiencing eyesight problems,

particularly when using computers during her digital literacy lessons. After the issue was reported, the Mentorship Department stepped in and facilitated her transport to and from the Kwaile Eye Centre, where she received specialized treatment and was prescribed medication to manage her allergy. The timely intervention restored her ability to continue with her classes comfortably and confidently.

At Kafuduni School for the Deaf, two students who had not reported to school due to financial difficulties were supported through the payment of their school fees. This intervention allowed them to resume learning and rejoin their peers, preventing further disruption of their education. Another case involved John Mwambire, a student facing serious health challenges that require corrective surgery to open his airway. As he awaits the procedure, the student depends on diapers to comfortably attend his classes, and the mentorship team, through Hope Spring support kit, provided the necessary assistance to ensure he continues learning without interruption.



Left- John Mwambire with his mother and sibling. Centre- John with one of the mentors together with his teacher. Right- John with his classmates



Left & Centre- Agnes Mupa and Benjamin Mutisya at their school during reporting day after being paid for part of their school levies. Right- Neema Ngala at the Kwale District Eye Centre.

Conclusion

As we reflect on the accomplishments of September, Kenya Keys remains deeply grateful to our sponsors, partners, and supporters whose unwavering commitment makes our work possible. Your generosity continues to open doors for countless students, giving them the opportunity to pursue education, grow in confidence, and build brighter futures.

We recognize that the journey of transforming communities through education is a collective effort. With your continued support, Kenya Keys reaffirms its dedication to empowering the youth of Taru and beyond especially through sustained educational sponsorship, mentorship, and community-based initiatives.

Together, we are not just changing lives, we are building a stronger and more hopeful future for generations to come.

Compiled and Prepared by:



Franciscah K. Muthami

Confirmed and Approved by:



Joseph Mwengea